

MOCKUP — not implemented, not produced by the package. Hand-illustrated to discuss “Design A” (stacked marks + since:), CLAUDE.md §6duodecies.

## If multi-round marking looked like this

### A passage edited across three rounds

One passage, one anchor family, three successive review rounds, nobody’s accepted anything as final yet – exactly the case since: exists for:

The treatment ~~has an effect~~<sup>[R1-2 · r1]</sup> has a clinically meaningful effect<sup>[R1-2 · r2]</sup> ~~, though only in the intention to treat population~~<sup>[R1-2 · r3]</sup> on survival.

What happened, in order: round 1, reviewer 1 asked for a stronger claim (struck old / underlined new, both blue). Round 2, the **same** reviewer asked for a caveat, added in a follow-up round (also blue — color encodes **reviewer**, not **round**, so nothing here visually tells the two rounds apart on its own). Round 3, the editor then asked to remove that very caveat (struck in editor-black, layered **on top of** the still-underlined round-2 addition, because the passage keeps every round’s history, not just the latest one).

Reading this one sentence now requires: identifying which colored span belongs to which round (color alone doesn’t say – only the superscript tag does), holding three edits to the same few words in mind at once, and mentally computing what the text **actually says right now** (a clinically meaningful effect on survival, no caveat – itself several inferential steps away from what’s on the page).

# The same passage, as a change-list row per round

Design A’s change-list() would need a Round column, and the same anchor keeps reappearing, once per round it was touched in – a change-list already meant to be checked off item by item (CLAUDE.md §6terdecies) grows one row per round, forever, in the same table:

| Round | Comment | Change            | Section      |
|-------|---------|-------------------|--------------|
| 1     | R1-2    | replacement       | Introduction |
| 2     | R1-2    | addition          | Introduction |
| 3     | R1-2    | deletion (editor) | Introduction |

Three rows for one sentence, and the count keeps climbing with every future round – a reviewer skimming this table to confirm nothing was missed has to notice that all three rows describe the **same** spot in the manuscript, not three different ones.

## What the letter would have to say

Without a round to compare against, “modified” is ambiguous the moment there’s more than one round of history. Design A resolves it with since:, but that pushes the ambiguity into prose the letter’s author now has to get right by hand:

#pinpoint(<r1-2>, since: 2) → “modified since round 2, p. 3”  
#pinpoint(<r1-2>, since: auto) → “modified since the original submission, p. 3”  
#xref(<r1-2>, since: 1) → a page reference, but **as the manuscript stood after round 1** – not as it reads today

Every citation from the letter now silently depends on a since: value the author must remember to set correctly for **that** round’s letter – get it wrong and the letter quotes or points at a version of the passage nobody is currently looking at.

## Design A vs. Design B, side by side

| Axis                          | A — stacked marks + since:                              | B — flatten between rounds                                                     |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Anchors                       | round-prefixed (2r1-2), never reused as-is              | reused freely, one round = one fresh compile                                   |
| Tracked manuscript, round $n$ | shows <b>every</b> round's marks at once, growing       | shows only round $n$ 's own marks — same size every time                       |
| change-list()                 | one row per round per touched anchor, grows forever     | one row per touched anchor, same as a single-round project                     |
| Letter wording                | needs since: almost everywhere once round $\geq 2$      | never needs it — “the manuscript” always means <b>this</b> round's             |
| History location              | inside the manuscript file itself, in Typst             | outside Typst — git history across per-round files/folders                     |
| New tooling required          | none — pure Typst, inside the package                   | an external flattener: parse .typ source, resolve accepted marks to plain text |
| Risk if something breaks      | contained to add/del/rep/pinpoint/change-list internals | a hand-written or generated flattener could silently mis-resolve a mark        |

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